UNIT 5: WHAT'S NEXT

TOPIC 1: SUCCESS AT WORK: TIPS FOR YOUR FIRST DAYS AT A NEW JOB

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Understand the importance of making a good impression his/her first days at a new job
- Understand how to make a good impression at work

Topic OUTCOME: The learner will:

- Identify the strategies that will work best for him/her
- Know how to use a checklist to prepare for their first day of a new job

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Alphabet Game

Objective: Students will review their knowledge of strategies for success at work.
Time: 15 minutes
Materials: Paper, pens/pencils, small prizes (optional)

Divide students into groups of 3-4. Ask each group to designate a writer. This person should get paper and a pen or pencil. Instruct the groups that they will have ten minutes to work together to think of a quality, characteristic or strategy for success at work that begins with each letter of the alphabet. Have students choose five strategies that they are willing to use to achieve success at work.

Skits/Large Group Discussion

Objectives:
- Students will understand the importance of making a good impression his/her first days at a new job.
- Students will understand how to make a good impression.

Time: 30 minutes
Materials: Handout: "Twenty Tips to Help You Make A Great Impression," "Twenty Tips" cut so that each tip is on a separate slip of paper, flipchart, markers

Pair students up. Pass out the cut up tips to the pairs so that pairs have the same number of tips (for example, six pairs each get three tips). Have the pairs create short skits to demonstrate the tip. At the end of each skit, the other students should try to figure out the tip. Students should not say the tip in their skit, but they can exaggerate that part of the skit they want people to focus on. Write what people think the tip is on flipchart (They might come up with other great tips). When all of the skits are complete, hand out "Twenty Tips to Help You Make A Great Impression." See how many of the tips people guessed correctly and discuss the tips to make sure everyone is clear on what the tip is suggesting. Have students identify which tips will be easy for them, which tips will take a little bit of work, but will be doable, and which tips will be challenging for them to follow.

Small Group Exercise

Objective: Students will know how to use a checklist to prepare for their first day of work.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Getting Ready to Start a New Job,"** paper, pens/pencils

Divide students into small groups. Instruct students to work together in their group to create a list of questions to ask/answer to prepare for your first day of work. After a few minutes, ask each group to pass their questions to the group to their right (or however you want to have them pass the questions). Give groups two minutes to add to the new list in front of them. Then have the groups pass the list again. Give groups two more minutes to add to the list in front of them. After looking at three lists, ask the small groups to come back together to the large group to discuss the activity.

Discussion Questions:

- Why is it important to prepare for your first day of work?
- If you could only ask your new employer one question to prepare for your first day of work, what would you ask? Why do you think this is the most important question?
- What is the second most important question? Why?
- What other questions did people come up with?
- Why is it important to have accurate information for your first day of work?
- What could you do if you did not have the right information and:
  - You were late for work
  - You were dressed inappropriately
  - You were missing important documents
  - You were supposed to bring lunch for a lunch meeting, but you didn't
  - You did not have equipment that you needed
  - You showed up at the wrong place
- If you do not have all of the information that you might want in order to be prepared for your first day of work, what should you do?

Hand out **"Getting Ready to Start a New Job."** Review the checklist with students. Is there anything on the checklist that they did not think about? Is there anything missing from the checklist? How could a checklist help you prepare for your first day of work?

Twenty Tips to Help You Make a Great Impression

1. **Have a positive attitude**
2. **Dress professionally/Blend in with your co-workers**
3. **Show your team spirit (Share your recognition with your team, at least initially)**
4. **Learn your co-workers' names**
5. **Ask questions/Ask for help**
6. **Take notes (You will not remember everything, and it does not leave a great impression to ask questions about something you have already been taught/told)**
7. **Be a self-starter; take the initiative to ask for more work**
8. **Learn everything about your new employer, even things that don't have to do with your position**
9. **Work full days "Come in early, stay a little later"**
10. **Avoid office politics and gossip**
11. **Keep personal business on company time to a minimum (emergencies only)**
12. **Take advantage of after-hours activities (Be on your best behavior — you are still with co-workers and/or your supervisor)**
13. **Listen more, Talk less (This is your time to listen and learn. If you do well, you will have a chance to make suggestions)**
14. **Track your accomplishments**
15. **Show appreciation**
16. **Find a mentor (This might not happen in your first few days, but start thinking about it early on and observing to see who might make a great mentor)**
17. **Get and stay organized/Set goals (Get an organizer or planner to keep track of your work, your schedule, meetings, deadlines, etc.)**
18. **Keep your boss informed — of everything (Meet regularly and make sure she/he knows you are a self-starter and hard-worker. Do not complain)**
19. **Meet and network with key people**
20. **Don't worry about being perfect (Remember to relax, keep your mind open, get to know your team members and do your work — and you should go far in making a lasting impression and reputation)**

Adapted from Your First Days Working at a New Job: 20 Tips to Help You Make a Great Impression *by Randall S. Hansen, Ph.D., and Katharine Hansen, Ph.D.*
http://www.quintcareers.com/first_days_working.html

Getting Ready to Start a New Job

Instructions: *Use this checklist as you prepare for your first day on the job. Call the personnel coordinator and get the appropriate information.*

1. Do I need a uniform? yes_____ no_____

   If yes:

   Do I need it on the first day?_____

   Where can I get it? _____

   What do I need to get? _____

   How many should I get? _____

   What is the cost? _____

   If no:

   What should I wear? _____

2. What time should I arrive? _____
3. Where should I report? _____
4. To whom should I report? _____
5. Do I need to bring any of the following forms? (check off which ones you need to bring)

   ___Document that establishes identity (birth certificate, driver's license, picture ID)

   ___Social Security card

   ___Work permit (if you are under 18)

   ___Occupational license (if needed)

   ___Unexpired Employment Authorization Card (if you are an immigrant)

   ___Medical records (physical, doctor's authorization to work)

6. What special equipment do I need? _____

   _____

7. What do people usually do for lunch? _____

   _____